

SATELLITE SOS MEETS CYBER-HYGIENE

Losing a signal on your phone while traveling outdoors shouldn't mean losing safety – or your data. Learn from 2025's smartest travelers, who carry two invisible life-lines – a sky-high connection and a rock-solid defense. Start with the built-in option: Apple's Emergency SOS via satellite, Google-Verizon's AstroText pilots, and Samsung's rumoured Orion link make it possible to ping rescue services straight from a modern flagship when towers vanish. Coverage is patchy and messages are plain-text, so backstop your phone with a pocket communicator such as Garmin inReach Mini 2 or ZOLEO. These palm-sized bricks pair with your handset, send GPS breadcrumbs every ten minutes, and let friends track you on a browser map.

Power is the next choke-point. Clip a 20,000 mAh PD power bank to your day-pack and stash a USB-C solar panel if you're trekking for days. Before wheels-up, download offline topo tiles on Google Maps and AllTrails, plus a local copy of crucial docs in an encrypted vault app like Proton Drive.

Now lock the digital doors. Public Wi-Fi in airports and cafés is a phishing pond: fire up a trusted VPN, switch your mobile OS to "MAC address randomization," and disable auto-join. eSIMs are convenient but note that shady marketplaces sometimes resell expired profiles – buy only from first-party carriers or vetted hubs such as Airalo and Nomad.

Add two-factor authentication to every cloud account, preferably with a hardware key on your key-ring; thief grabs your phone, but can't loot the vault. Turn on "Stolen Device Protection" (iOS) or "Android Auto-Lock" so the handset demands biometrics before showing passwords. Finally, train your camera on that QR code in the taxi before scanning – many apps (Google Lens, Kaspersky QR Scanner) flag malicious links on sight. If a link looks fishy, type the URL manually.

27 Gimbal stabilizers (like DJI Osmo Mobile) provide steady video recording when roaming scenic viewpoints.

28 Instant print cameras such as Fujifilm Instax Mini Link allow instant printing of memories – ideal for scrapbooking or sharing with others en route.

CONNECTIVITY

29 Rent or buy an international eSIM card (e.g., Airalo) for affordable data usage abroad without needing physical SIM cards.

30 Use apps like Speedify to boost internet speed by combining multiple networks (Wi-Fi + mobile data).

31 Download offline maps on Google Maps or Maps.me before heading to remote areas without connectivity – this ensures you'll never get lost even without internet access.

SAFETY AND SECURITY TIPS

21 Carry a travel power strip that is light in weight with USB ports so that you can charge several devices at once in hotel rooms that have limited outlets.

smartphones – it's thin but useful for working on the go.

GADGETS FOR PHOTOGRAPHY

22 Carry extra charging cables for all your devices as emergency backups.

25 Get smartphones with high-end cameras (e.g., iPhone 16 Pro, Samsung Galaxy Ultra S25 or Google Pixel 9) for pro-quality pictures without lugging heavy gear.

23 Use a portable SSD or USB for backing up photos and videos while traveling – don't risk losing those memories!

26 Compact action cameras such as GoPro Hero series, DJI Osmo or Insta360 are ideal for adventure pursuits like hiking, snorkeling, or zip-lining.

24 Bring a foldable Bluetooth keyboard for productivity on the move with tablets or

32 Install VPN software like NordVPN, Surfshark or ExpressVPN to protect internet connections over public Wi-Fi at airports or cafes.

33 Utilize smart locks for bags that can be opened through Bluetooth or fingerprint readers for extra security.

34 Install device location apps like Find My iPhone or Google Find My Device in the event of theft or loss during your travels – it's better safe than sorry!